



Using Ansible for Managing VMware Infrastructure

This article is an introduction to different Ansible modules, which can be used to manage various VMware objects in VMware infrastructure.

Ansible is an IT automation tool. It can configure systems, deploy software and orchestrate advanced IT tasks such as continuous deployments or zero downtime rolling updates. Many of you already know that you can manage your VMware infrastructure using Ansible.

A recent development branch of Ansible, i.e., 2.4-devel (<https://github.com/ansible/ansible/tree/devel>), has brought in a lot of improvements in both its performance and its reliability.

Managing the ESXi host with different tools

The vSphere Client and the vSphere Web Client provide simple ways to manage your ESXi host and operate its virtual machines.

Another way of managing this is the Virtualisation Management Object Management Infrastructure's (VMOMI) network exposed API. VMOMI can be used by various programming language bindings like PyVmomi (<https://github.com/vmware/pyvmomi>).

Getting started with Ansible

You can read more about Ansible official documentation at <http://docs.ansible.com>. Also, *Open Source For You* has covered various Ansible related topics in past editions.

Let us discuss a few Ansible VMware modules that are essential for managing and administering various VMware objects.